

Lily and the Secret Village Treasure

Hidden treasure story • 3-4 years old



Once upon a time, in a sunny, cheerful village, there lived a little girl named Lily. Lily loved adventures and exploring new places. One bright morning, her Grandma gave her an old map. « **Lily,** » Grandma said with a twinkle in her eye, « **there's a hidden treasure in our village. Would you like to find it?** »

Lily's eyes sparkled with excitement. « **Yes, Grandma! I want to find the treasure!** » she exclaimed.

With her trusty stuffed bear, Benny, tucked under her arm, Lily set off on her adventure. The map showed a big, friendly tree by the pond as the first stop. Lily hummed a happy tune as she walked, Benny bouncing gently by her side.

When she reached the big tree, she found a shiny rock nearby. It had an arrow pointing to the flower garden. « **Look, Benny! We need to go to the flower garden,** » Lily said joyfully. Benny nodded, his button eyes twinkling in the sunshine.

As they reached the flower garden, the air smelled sweet like candy. Butterflies danced around, their wings like rainbows. Lily spotted a small wooden sign hidden among the roses. It said, « **Follow the sound of the chirping birds.** »

Lily listened carefully. She heard happy chirping coming from the playground. « **Let's go to the playground, Benny!** » she giggled, and off they went.

At the playground, children were laughing and playing. Lily saw a big slide that looked like a dragon. Near the dragon slide, she found a paper note. It read, « **You're getting closer! Head to the big oak tree.** »

The big oak tree was just beyond the playground. Its branches stretched wide, like welcoming arms. As Lily approached, she saw something sparkling beneath its roots. It was a small wooden chest. « **We found it, Benny!** » Lily cheered.

Inside the chest, she found colorful marbles, a shiny whistle, and a little card. The card said, « **You found the treasure! The real treasure is the fun and adventure you had along the way.** »

Lily smiled, her heart warm and full. She hugged Benny tight and whispered, « **It was the best adventure, wasn't it?** »

Just then, Grandma appeared, clapping her hands. « **Well done, my brave explorer!** » she said, giving Lily a big hug. « **You showed courage and cleverness.** »

Lily grinned up at Grandma. « **It was so much fun, and I loved every moment!** » she said, feeling proud.

Together, they walked back home, with Lily telling Grandma all about the wonderful clues and places they visited. The sun began to set, painting the sky with pinks and oranges.

That night, as Lily snuggled into bed with Benny, she knew that the real treasure was the joy of adventure and the love of family. And with that happy thought, she drifted off to sleep, dreaming of more adventures to come.

The quiz: did you understand the story well?

1) Who is the little girl in the story?

- Lily
- Emma
- Sophie
- Mia

2) What did Grandma give Lily?

- A map
- A cookie
- A toy car
- A hat

3) What did Lily find under the big oak tree?

- A wooden chest
- A bicycle
- A puppy
- A cake

4) What was the real treasure in the story?

- The fun and adventure
- A pile of gold
- A big toy
- A magic wand

Correct answers:

1) Lily 2) A map 3) A wooden chest 4) The fun and adventure

Glossary: complicated words in the story

Village: A small place where many houses and people live close together.

Adventure: A fun, new trip where you might see new things and feel excited.

Map: A paper picture that shows where places are and how to go.

Twinkle: A tiny, quick bright light, like a small star or happy eye light.

Trusty: Something you can always count on to help you and stay safe.

Stuffed bear: A soft toy animal filled with cotton or fluff to hug and play.

Pond: A small, quiet water place where frogs, ducks, or fish can live.

Butterflies: Insects with pretty wings that fly from flower to flower.

Roses: Pretty flowers that smell nice and often have soft, colorful petals.

Chirping: Short, happy bird sounds you hear in trees or outside.

Playground: A place with swings and slides where children run and play.

Oak tree: A very strong tree with big leaves and a thick trunk.

Branches: The long parts that grow out from a tree trunk like arms.

Roots: The parts under the ground that hold a plant and drink water.

Chest: A wooden box that can keep special things safe inside.

Marbles: Small, round, shiny glass balls children play games with.